Chapter 2 — Technology & Internet

IELTS Writing Band 7 — 6-Week Master Preparation System

Study material for guided and independent practice.
Read actively — this is training material, not a text to memorize.

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Part A — Topic Map

Technology is one of the most common and fastest-changing IELTS Writing themes. Before studying the full material below, look over the ten directions examiners commonly test.

Sub-topic	Typical angle examiners test
Technology and education	Classroom tools vs traditional teaching; engagement vs distraction
Employment	Automation replacing jobs; new skills needed; job security
AI and automation	Efficiency vs unemployment; which roles are safe; retraining
Communication	Speed and convenience vs weaker personal connection
Social media	Mental health, relationships, misinformation, self-image
Internet benefits / drawbacks	Access to knowledge vs addiction, distraction, reliability of sources
Privacy and cybersecurity	Data collection; surveillance; fraud; who is responsible
Healthcare	Diagnosis and treatment improvements vs cost, access, and trust
Environment	Technology as a cause of damage vs a tool for solutions
Lifestyle	Convenience and comfort vs inactivity and dependency

The pilot topic developed in full detail below is **Artificial Intelligence and Automation**. It overlaps naturally with the Employment sub-topic and demonstrates the complete study method for the rest of this chapter.

Part B — Reading Passage: Artificial Intelligence and Automation in the Workplace

Over the past decade, artificial intelligence (AI) and automated systems have transformed numerous industries, from manufacturing and logistics to finance and customer service. While this technological shift has considerably improved **efficiency** and reduced operating costs for businesses, it has also raised serious concerns about the future of human employment.

One of the clearest benefits of automation lies in its ability to handle **repetitive tasks** far more reliably than human workers. Machines guided by sophisticated **algorithms** can repeat the same action continuously, with greater speed and fewer errors. In manufacturing, for example, robotic arms can assemble products around the clock without requiring breaks or salaries, allowing companies to lower prices while simultaneously increasing output. Similarly, AI-powered customer service tools can resolve simple enquiries instantly, freeing human staff to concentrate on more complex or sensitive cases that require genuine empathy. Such gains in **productivity** ultimately benefit consumers, who gain access to cheaper goods and faster services.

However, this same efficiency has a troubling side effect: it can render certain jobs **redundant**. Positions that mainly involve **menial** or repetitive labour, such as basic data entry, assembly-line work, or routine customer enquiries, are particularly vulnerable, since algorithms can now perform them at a fraction of the cost. Call centres that once employed hundreds of staff to answer routine questions have, in some cases, reduced their workforce by half after introducing automated systems capable of handling the majority of enquiries. As a result, many workers face a genuine threat to their **job security**, particularly those with limited formal education or specialised skills. Economists warn that without intervention, automation could **displace** millions of workers worldwide over the coming decades, deepening existing income inequality.

Fortunately, this outcome is not inevitable. Governments and businesses that invest early in **upskilling** and **retrain**ing programs can help workers transition into roles that technology cannot easily replace, such as those requiring creativity, emotional

intelligence, or complex problem-solving. For example, a factory worker who previously operated machinery manually might retrain as a technician responsible for maintaining and programming the very robots that replaced the original task. Education systems, too, have a role to play by preparing young people for a labour market in which digital literacy and adaptability will matter more than any single technical skill.

In conclusion, automation and artificial intelligence offer undeniable advantages in terms of efficiency and productivity, but they also pose a direct challenge to traditional employment. The overall impact on society will depend less on the technology itself than on how governments, businesses, and individuals respond to it. With sufficient investment in education and retraining, the transition towards an automated economy could ultimately benefit most workers rather than leaving many of them behind.

Part C — 10 High-Value Vocabulary Items

Word / Phrase	Simple Meaning	Useful Collocation	IELTS-Style Example
redundant	no longer needed, especially a job role	render workers redundant	The introduction of self-checkout machines has rendered many cashier positions redundant.
efficiency	achieving results without wasting time or resources	improve efficiency	Automating the sorting process significantly improved the warehouse's overall efficiency.
repetitive tasks	actions performed the same way repeatedly	automate repetitive tasks	Factories increasingly automate repetitive tasks to reduce production costs.
retrain	to teach someone new skills for a new role	retrain for a new role	The government offered funding to help former coal miners retrain for jobs in renewable energy.
algorithm	a precise set of instructions a computer follows	sophisticated algorithms	Streaming services use sophisticated algorithms to recommend content based on viewing habits.
productivity	the rate at which goods or services are produced	boost productivity	Investing in modern equipment can significantly boost a factory's productivity.

job security	confidence that one will keep one's employment	threaten job security	Rapid automation has begun to threaten job security in several manufacturing sectors.
menial	requiring little skill; considered unskilled	menial labour	Robots are now capable of performing menial labour once reserved for low-paid workers.
displace	to force someone out of a job, often by replacing them	displace human workers	Self-driving vehicles could eventually displace millions of professional drivers worldwide.
upskilling	the process of learning new or advanced skills	invest in upskilling	Many companies now invest in upskilling programs to prepare employees for technical roles.

Part D — Collocation Bank

- automate repetitive tasks
- render jobs obsolete
- bridge the skills gap
- invest in retraining programs
- widen income inequality
- adapt to technological change

Part E — Idea Bank

Formula: **Idea → Why → How → Result → Example**

POSITIVE **AI and automation significantly increase productivity for businesses.**

Why? Machines can work continuously without fatigue, holidays, or errors caused by tiredness.

How? Algorithms handle repetitive or data-heavy tasks far faster than humans, freeing staff for higher-value work.

Result? Companies can produce more goods or services at a lower cost, often passing savings on to consumers.

Example? An online retailer using automated warehouses can process thousands of orders overnight that would previously have required a full night shift of workers.

NEGATIVE **Automation threatens the job security of workers in low-skilled roles.**

Why? Repetitive, predictable tasks are the easiest for algorithms and robots to replicate.

How? Employers replace human staff with machines wherever the task can be standardised.

Result? Workers with limited formal education may struggle to find comparable employment elsewhere.

Example? Supermarket chains that introduce self-checkout systems typically need far fewer till operators than before.

INDIVIDUAL **Workers themselves must take responsibility for continuously updating their skills.**

Why? No single skill set remains valuable indefinitely as technology evolves.

How? Employees can pursue evening courses, online certifications, or professional development programs.

Result? Those who adapt remain employable even as their original role disappears.

Example? A bank clerk who learns data analysis may move into a technical role as cashier positions decline.

GOVERNMENT **Governments can soften the impact of automation through retraining and social support.**

Why? Market forces alone rarely protect workers who lose their jobs to technology.

How? Public funding for retraining schemes, unemployment benefits, and education reform can ease the transition.

Result? Displaced workers are more likely to find new employment rather than remaining jobless long-term.

Example? Some governments fund free technical courses for factory workers whose roles have been automated.

SOLUTION **A balanced approach combining automation with human oversight benefits both businesses and workers.**

Why? Machines excel at repetitive tasks, while humans remain essential for judgment, empathy, and creativity.

How? Companies can automate routine processes while reassigning staff to roles requiring interpersonal or complex skills.

Result? Businesses gain efficiency without creating mass unemployment, and workers move into more meaningful roles.

Example? A hospital may use AI to analyse scans quickly, while doctors focus on diagnosis, treatment decisions, and patient care.

Part F — Reusable Sentence Patterns

1. Pattern: "One of the main advantages/disadvantages of X is that..." — *Function:* introduce a key point.
Example: One of the main disadvantages of widespread automation is that it can eliminate entry-level jobs that young workers once relied on to gain experience.

2. Pattern: "Although X can provide several benefits, it may also..." — *Function:* concede a point before countering it.
Example: Although artificial intelligence can provide several benefits in healthcare, it may also raise concerns about accountability when a diagnosis proves incorrect.

3. Pattern: "This is particularly true/beneficial for..., as..." — *Function:* narrow a claim to a specific group.
Example: This is particularly true for manufacturing workers, as their roles often involve the kind of repetitive tasks that robots can perform most easily.

4. Pattern: "Unless appropriate measures are introduced, ..." — *Function:* warn of a consequence, implying a solution is needed.
Example: Unless appropriate measures are introduced, the gap between highly skilled professionals and displaced manual workers will likely continue to widen.

5. Pattern: "X, which can result in Y." — *Function:* link cause and effect with a relative clause.
Example: Automated systems can process thousands of transactions per second, which can result in significant cost savings for financial institutions.

6. Pattern: "By doing X, institutions/governments can..." — *Function:* describe a solution with a participle structure.
Example: By funding large-scale retraining programs, governments can help displaced workers transition into emerging industries.

7. Pattern: "Consequently, ..." — *Function:* signal a logical result at the end of an argument.
Example: Consequently, employees who continuously update their digital skills are far less likely to be replaced by automated systems.

8. Pattern: "It is often argued that..., although..." — *Function:* present a common view before gently challenging it.

Example: It is often argued that automation destroys more jobs than it creates, although historically new technologies have also generated entirely new industries and roles.

Part G — Paraphrasing Practice

1. Original

> *Many jobs will be lost to robots and artificial intelligence in the future.*

Key concepts: jobs; robots; AI; future; loss of employment.
Possible transformations: "jobs will be lost to" → "positions are likely to be eliminated by"; nominalize.
Model paraphrase: A significant number of positions are likely to be eliminated by robotics and artificial intelligence in the coming years.
Why it works: The passive structure and vocabulary changed while the core claim remained intact.

2. Original

> *Social media has made it easier for people to stay in touch with friends and family.*

Key concepts: social media; communication; friends/family; ease of contact.
Possible transformations: reconstruct; "has made it easier" → "has considerably simplified".
Model paraphrase: Platforms such as social media have considerably simplified the process of maintaining contact with friends and relatives.
Why it works: A Method C reconstruction preserves meaning through a different sentence structure.

3. Original

> *The internet provides people with instant access to information.*

Key concepts: internet; access; information; speed.
Possible transformations: shift subject focus from "the internet" to "individuals".

Model paraphrase: Thanks to the internet, individuals can now obtain information almost instantly.
Why it works: The sentence focus shifted from the tool to the user, a natural alternative perspective (Method D).

4. Original

> *Many people are worried that technology companies collect too much personal data.*

Key concepts: technology companies; personal data; privacy concern.
Possible transformations: "are worried that" → "there is growing concern that"; word form changes.
Model paraphrase: There is growing concern that technology firms gather an excessive amount of personal information about their users.
Why it works: An impersonal reporting structure replaces "many people are worried", a natural Band 7+ alternative.

5. Original

> *Automation can increase a company's efficiency but may also eliminate jobs.*

Key concepts: automation; efficiency; job losses; mixed effect.
Possible transformations: use a concession structure ("while...").
Model paraphrase: While automation can significantly improve a company's efficiency, it may simultaneously result in considerable job losses.
Why it works: The balanced two-part claim is preserved using a concession pattern rather than word-for-word substitution.

Part H — Idea-Development Exercises

Instructions: Try developing each basic idea yourself using **WHY → HOW → RESULT → EXAMPLE** before reading the model answers that follow.

1. Social media can negatively affect mental health.
2. Self-driving cars will make roads safer.
3. Governments should regulate how companies use personal data.

Model Answers

1. Social media can negatively affect mental health.

Why? Constant exposure to curated images of other people's lives can create unrealistic comparisons.

How? Users, especially teenagers, scroll through filtered photos and exaggerated achievements for hours each day.

Result? Many develop feelings of inadequacy, anxiety, or low self-esteem.

Example? Studies have linked heavy social media use among adolescents to increased rates of reported anxiety and body-image concerns.

2. Self-driving cars will make roads safer.

Why? Most traffic accidents are caused by human error, such as distraction, fatigue, or poor judgement.

How? Autonomous vehicles use sensors and algorithms to react more quickly and consistently than human drivers.

Result? The overall accident rate could fall significantly as human-caused errors are removed from the equation.

Example? Early trials of self-driving vehicles have shown considerably lower collision rates than vehicles driven by distracted or tired human drivers.

3. Governments should regulate how companies use personal data.

Why? Technology companies often collect vast amounts of personal information without users fully understanding how it will be used.

How? Clear regulations can require companies to obtain informed consent and limit how long data is stored.

Result? Individuals gain more control over their privacy, and the risk of data misuse or theft is reduced.

Example? Some regions now require companies to explain data collection in plain language and allow users to request deletion of their information.

Part I — IELTS Question Bank

1. Some people believe that artificial intelligence will eventually replace most human jobs. To what extent do you agree or disagree? *(Opinion / Agree–Disagree)*
2. The increasing use of automation in the workplace has both advantages and disadvantages. Discuss. *(Advantages–Disadvantages)*
3. Social media has changed the way people communicate with one another. Do the advantages of this outweigh the disadvantages? *(Advantages Outweigh Disadvantages)*
4. Some people think that the internet has made the world a better place, while others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion. *(Discuss Both Views)*
5. Companies and governments collect increasing amounts of personal data. What problems does this cause, and what solutions can you suggest? *(Problem/Cause + Solution)*
6. Some people believe modern technology has helped solve environmental problems, while others believe it is a major cause of environmental damage. Discuss both views and give your opinion. *(Discuss Both Views)*
7. Some people believe that technology has improved healthcare significantly, while others think it has created new problems. Discuss both views and give your opinion. *(Discuss Both Views)*
8. Modern technology allows many people to work from home instead of commuting to an office. Is this a positive or negative development? *(Two-Part / Direct Question)*
9. Some people argue that children today spend too much time using digital devices, which negatively affects their development. To what extent do you agree or disagree? *(Opinion / Agree–Disagree)*
10. In many countries, cybercrime and online fraud are increasing. What are the causes of this, and what measures could reduce it? *(Problem/Cause + Solution)*

Next step: Review this chapter, then apply the same template to a second Technology sub-topic — most likely **Social Media** or **Privacy & Cybersecurity** — before moving on to Chapter 3 (Environment).